

# Understand the context first.

Do this once per place, before Tool 1. It takes a few days. Skipping it is how researchers end up translating their own assumptions.

- ☐ **Set the research question, consent and deletion rules**  
What you will record, who can hear it, and when it gets deleted.
- ☐ **Spend time with a local guide and varied local people**  
Before any interview. Listen to how people talk to each other.
- ☐ **Notice routines, relationships, language, communication**  
Who speaks first? Which language is used for what?
- ☐ **Record possible meanings and their limits**  
Write down what a phrase might mean, and what you can't know yet.
- ☐ **Write your positionality note**  
Below. Your language, your background, what you might mishear.
- ☐ **Build a provisional codebook, glossary and interview guide**  
Provisional means it will change after Tool 2.

POSITIONALITY NOTE

Languages I speak, and how well

Where I grew up; where they grew up

What I might hear as "normal"

Words I tend to over-read

Who will help me when I don't understand

PROVISIONAL GLOSSARY · START IT HERE, CORRECT IT IN TOOL 2

| WORD OR PHRASE, AS HEARD | MIGHT MEAN | CAN'T KNOW YET |
|--------------------------|------------|----------------|
|                          |            |                |
|                          |            |                |
|                          |            |                |

NEXT PAGE **Tool 1 • Listen** →